HUMOR STYLES QUESTIONNAIRE

Source:

> Martin, R. A., Puhlik-Doris, P., Larsen, G., Gray, J., & Weir, K. (2003). Individual differences in uses of humor and their relation to psychological well-being: Development of the Humor Styles Questionnaire. *Journal of Research in Personality, 37*, 48-75.

Extensive psychometric details are found here:

> Paul J. Silvia & Rebekah M. Rodriguez (2020). Time to renovate the Humor Styles Questionnaire? An item response theory analysis of the HSQ. *Behavioral Sciences, 10*(11), 173. https://doi.org/10.3390/bs10110173

Notes:

The HSQ has four subscales. It is usually used with a 1-7 response scale, sometimes used with a 1-5 response scale, which is probably better (see https://doi.org/10.3390/bs10110173). Reverse-coded items are marked with an asterisk (*). The items should be presented in a mixed or random order.

AFFILIATIVE STYLE

*I usually don't laugh or joke around much with other people.

I don't have to work very hard at making other people laugh—I seem to be a naturally humorous person.

*I rarely make other people laugh by telling funny stories about myself.

I laugh and joke a lot with my closest friends.

*I usually don't like to tell jokes or amuse people.

I enjoy making people laugh.

*I don't often joke around with my friends.

*I usually can't think of witty things to say when I'm with other people.

SELF-ENHANCING STYLE

If I am feeling depressed, I can usually cheer myself up with humor.

Even when I'm by myself, I'm often amused by the absurdities of life.

If I am feeling upset or unhappy I usually try to think of something funny about the situation to make myself feel better.

My humorous outlook on life keeps me from getting overly upset or depressed about things.

If I'm by myself and I'm feeling unhappy, I make an effort to think of something funny to cheer myself up.

*If I am feeling sad or upset, I usually lose my sense of humor.

It is my experience that thinking about some amusing aspect of a situation is often a very effective way of coping with problems.

I don't need to be with other people to feel amused – I can usually find things to laugh about even when I'm by myself.

AGGRESSIVE STYLE

If someone makes a mistake, I will often tease them about it.

*People are never offended or hurt by my sense of humor.

When telling jokes or saying funny things, I am usually not very concerned about how other people are taking it.

*I do not like it when people use humor as a way of criticizing or putting someone down.

Sometimes I think of something that is so funny that I can't stop myself from saying it, even if it is not appropriate for the situation.

*I never participate in laughing at others even if all my friends are doing it.

If I don't like someone, I often use humor or teasing to put them down.

*Even if something is really funny to me, I will not laugh or joke about it if someone will be offended.

SELF-DEFEATING STYLE

I let people laugh at me or make fun at my expense more than I should.

I will often get carried away in putting myself down if it makes my family or friends laugh.

I often try to make people like or accept me more by saying something funny about my own weaknesses, blunders, or faults.

*I don't often say funny things to put myself down.

I often go overboard in putting myself down when I am making jokes or trying to be funny.

When I am with friends or family, I often seem to be the one that other people make fun of or joke about.

If I am having problems or feeling unhappy, I often cover it up by joking around, so that even my closest friends don't know how I really feel.

Letting others laugh at me is my way of keeping my friends and family in good spirits.